

GMDC Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation Ltd.

(A Government of Gujarat Enterprise)

MINES & MINERALS



As India steps into a decade of rapid industrial expansion and energy transition, mineral security has become a national priority. A country that aims to build its own clean energy systems, electronics and defence manufacturing needs assured access to the minerals that sustain these sectors. This is where State PSUs such as Gujarat Mineral Development Corporation play a steady role. Their work goes beyond extraction, shaping long-term resilience and supporting the country's shift towards self-reliance under initiatives like Atmanirbhar Bharat and the National Critical Mineral Mission. GMDC's expansion reflects this shift

clearly. Commercial coal operations in Odisha, across the Baitarni West, Burapahar and Kudanali Lubri blocks, hold more than two billion tonnes of geological resources and are designed to strengthen India's base load fuel requirement while reducing reliance on imported thermal coal. These projects mark GMDC's transition from a state-focused mining company to a national contributor, supported by cleaner approaches such as Underground Coal Gasification and planned pathways for emerging fuels like blue hydrogen and SynGas.

Alongside coal, GMDC is building capacity in critical minerals that will define

India's technological and clean energy future. The rare earth ecosystem being developed at Ambadungar in Bharuch is one of the country's most integrated rare earth efforts, with the ability to produce Mixed Rare Earth Carbonate and Neodymium Praseodymium oxide for applications ranging from EV motors to wind turbines. The Ambaji copper project strengthens this chain further, with reserves of copper, zinc and lead planned to be processed through a beneficiation plant with a long operational life.

Together, these projects help reduce import dependence and create new industrial linkages within the country. In Gujarat, GMDC continues to anchor the state's energy and industrial landscape. Six new lignite mines across Kutch and South Gujarat will add nearly five hundred million tonnes of reserves that will support MSMEs in ceramics, chemicals and other energy-dependent sectors. These reserves will act as reliable fuel sources that reduce the state's exposure to imported coal and help maintain industrial continuity.

The limestone corridor in Western Kutch adds another layer of capability, with significant reserves and long-term supply agreements that will pave the way for new cement units and a broader value chain development.

All of this reflects a steady and institution-driven approach India will need in the years ahead. Mineral security cannot be built on short-term projects. It requires organisations to think long-term, carry public responsibility and build ecosystems around every resource they develop. GMDC's work across lignite, coal, rare earths, copper and limestone shows how a state PSU can anchor domestic value chains, reduce vulnerabilities and support national missions with grounded execution. In doing so, it strengthens not just industries and regions, but the country's larger path towards self-reliance.

